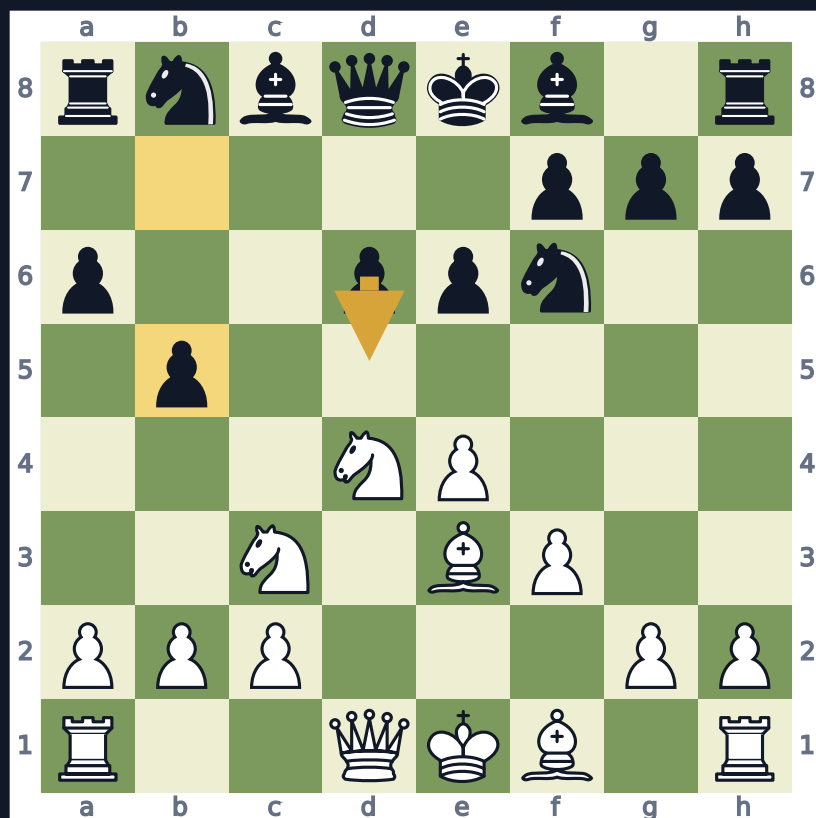


05

Najdorf English Attack

Opposite-side castling, pawn-storm timing, and the defensive resources that keep Black alive.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will learn the race as a sequence of forcing events and know when central action outranks another wing pawn move.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 025 | PAGE 4

Decode: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup

In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

LESSON 026 | PAGE 8

Play: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup

In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

LESSON 027 | PAGE 12

Decode: The ...Ng4 disruption

Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

LESSON 028 | PAGE 16

Play: The ...Ng4 disruption

Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

LESSON 029 | PAGE 20

Decode: The ...e5 English Attack structure

In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

LESSON 030 | PAGE 24

Play: The ...e5 English Attack structure

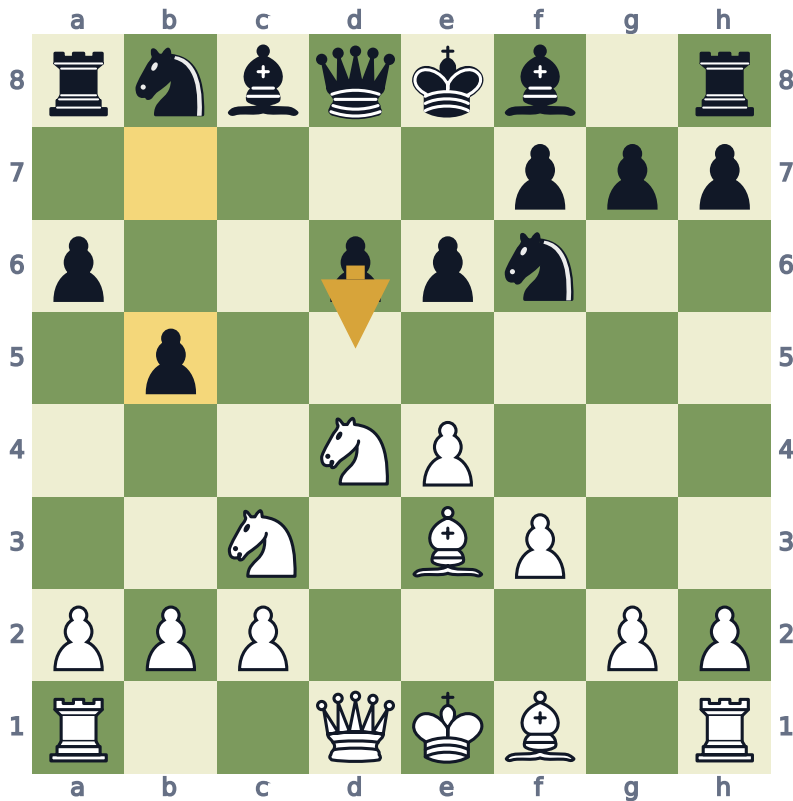
In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will learn the race as a sequence of forcing events and know when central action outranks another wing pawn move.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock.

DECISION RULE

Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...b5, ...Bb7, ...Nbd7, and the c-file, while keeping ...d5 or ...h5 as tactical brakes.

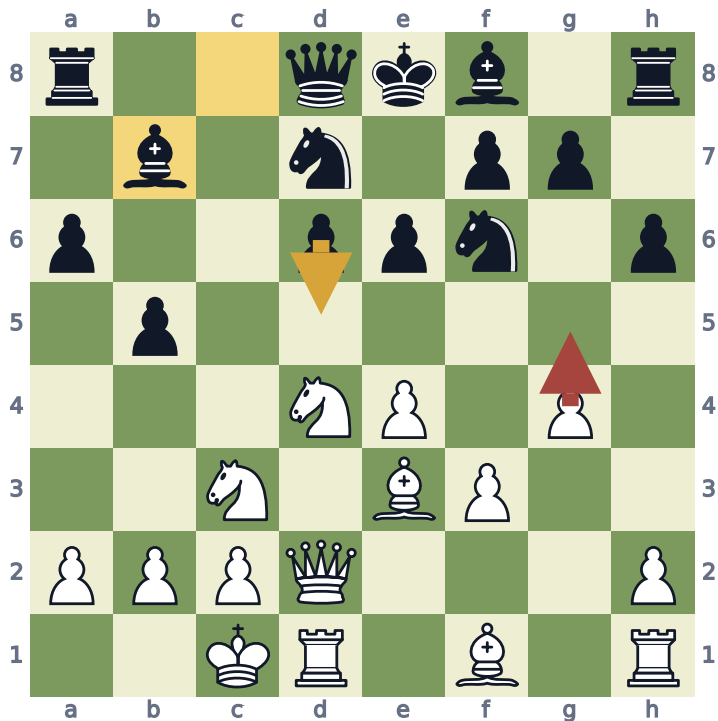
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king.

MEMORY RULE | In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...b5, ...Bb7, ...Nbd7, and the c-file, while keeping ...d5 or ...h5 as tactical brakes.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king.

FAILURE MODE

Making a quiet improving move when the opponent already has a forcing sequence.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

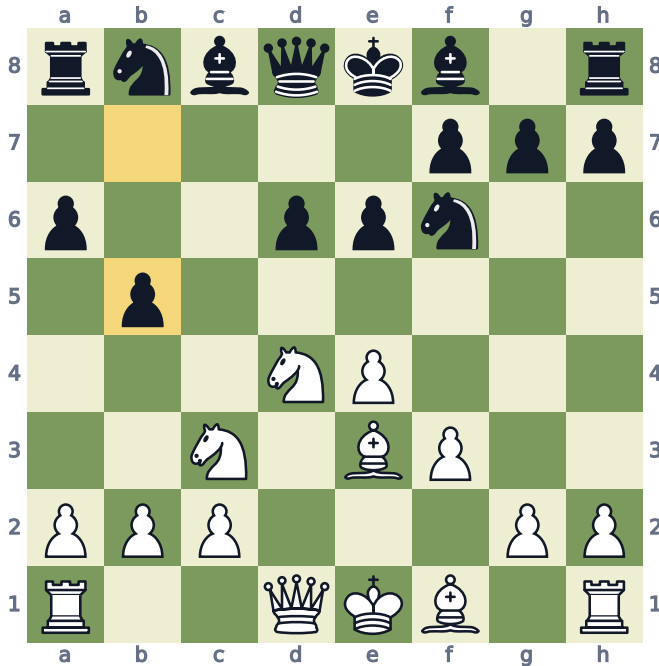
RULE | In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7



- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king? White's resistance is: White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king. The line fails as a template when: Making a quiet improving move when the opponent already has a forcing sequence.

STORE THIS | In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

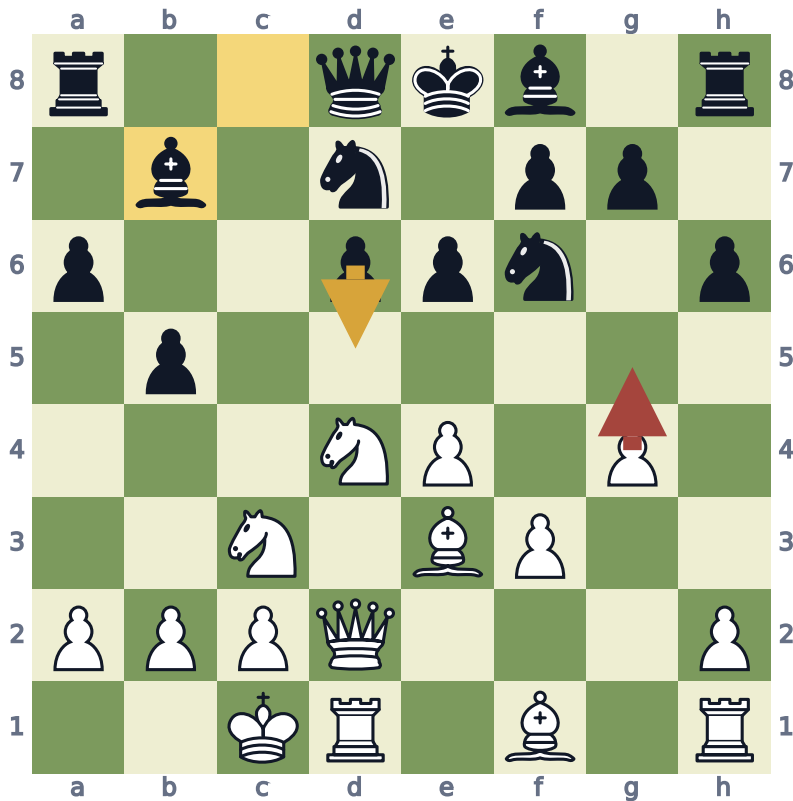
1. White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock. 2. Use ...b5, ...Bb7, ...Nbd7, and the c-file, while keeping ...d5 or ...h5 as tactical brakes. 3. White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king. 4. Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king? 5. Making a quiet improving move when the opponent already has a forcing sequence.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock.

DECISION RULE

Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...b5, ...Bb7, ...Nbd7, and the c-file, while keeping ...d5 or ...h5 as tactical brakes.

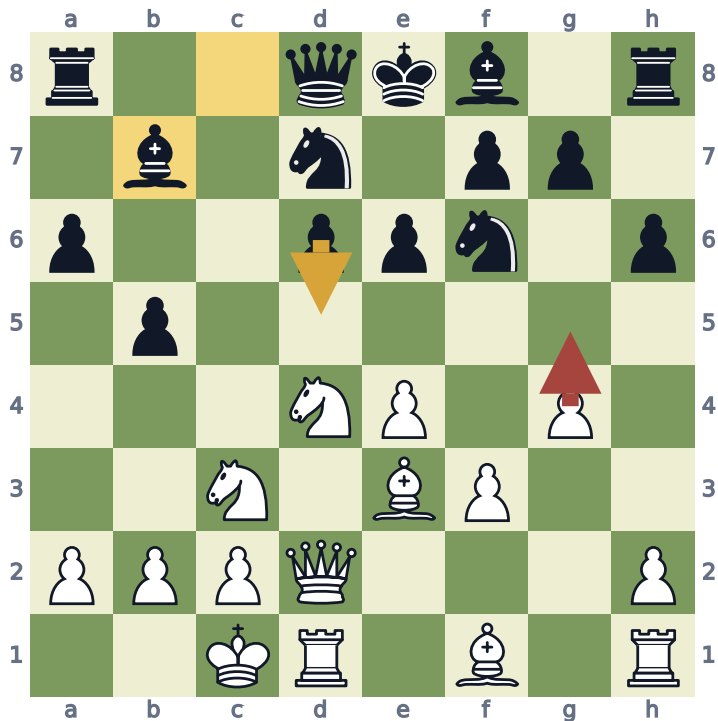
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king.

MEMORY RULE | In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...b5, ...Bb7, ...Nbd7, and the c-file, while keeping ...d5 or ...h5 as tactical brakes.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king.

FAILURE MODE

Making a quiet improving move when the opponent already has a forcing sequence.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

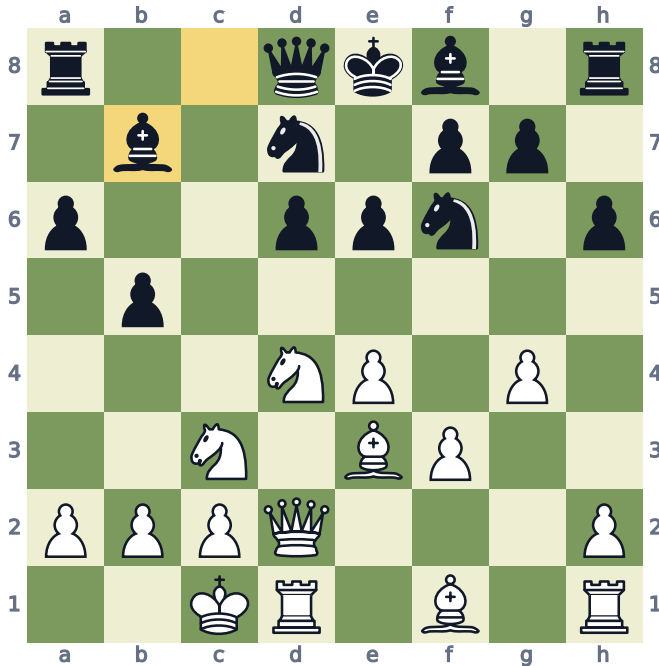
RULE | In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7



- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- g4: White starts a direct pawn storm and threatens to gain time on the f6 knight.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- O-O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king? White's resistance is: White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king. The line fails as a template when: Making a quiet improving move when the opponent already has a forcing sequence.

STORE THIS | In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

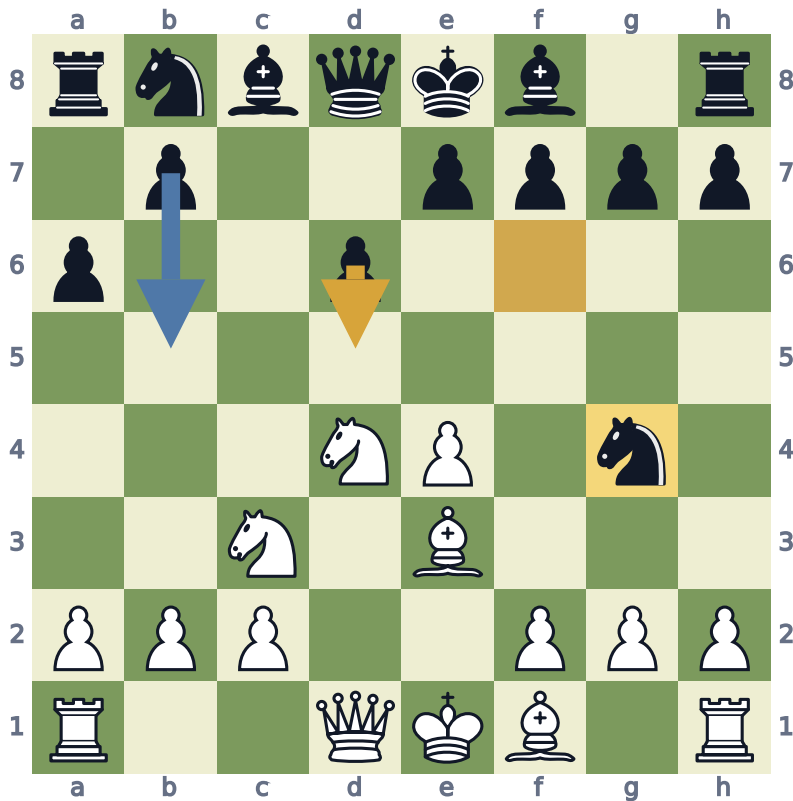
1. White's pieces and pawns point at the kingside while Black's queenside play targets the castled king; development speed sets the race clock. 2. Use ...b5, ...Bb7, ...Nbd7, and the c-file, while keeping ...d5 or ...h5 as tactical brakes. 3. White pushes g4-g5 and h4-h5, opens files, and often sacrifices material to expose Black's king. 4. Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king? 5. Making a quiet improving move when the opponent already has a forcing sequence.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The ...Ng4 disruption

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares.

DECISION RULE

Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use the gained bishop tempo to seize kingside space, then return to development before the advanced pawns become targets.

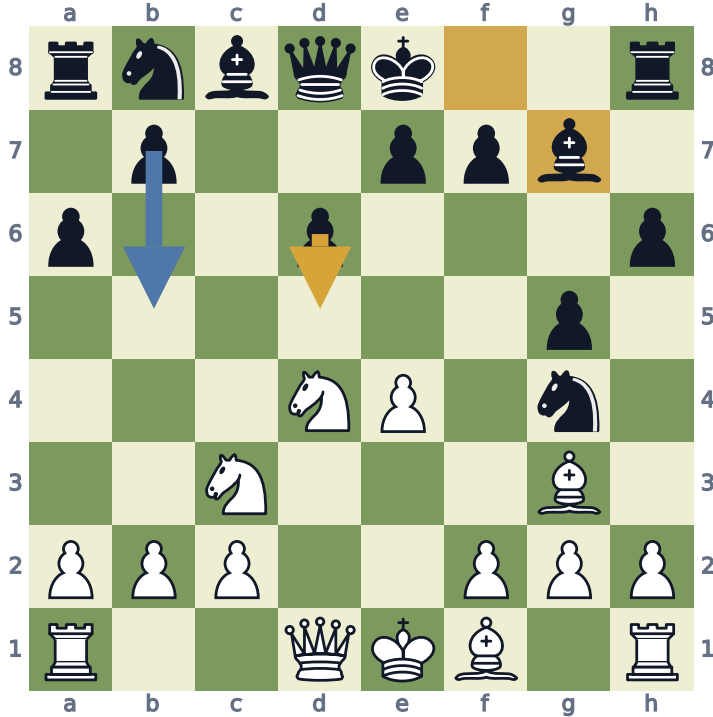
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares.

MEMORY RULE | Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use the gained bishop tempo to seize kingside space, then return to development before the advanced pawns become targets.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares.

FAILURE MODE

Continuing the pawn chase after its strategic purpose is complete.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

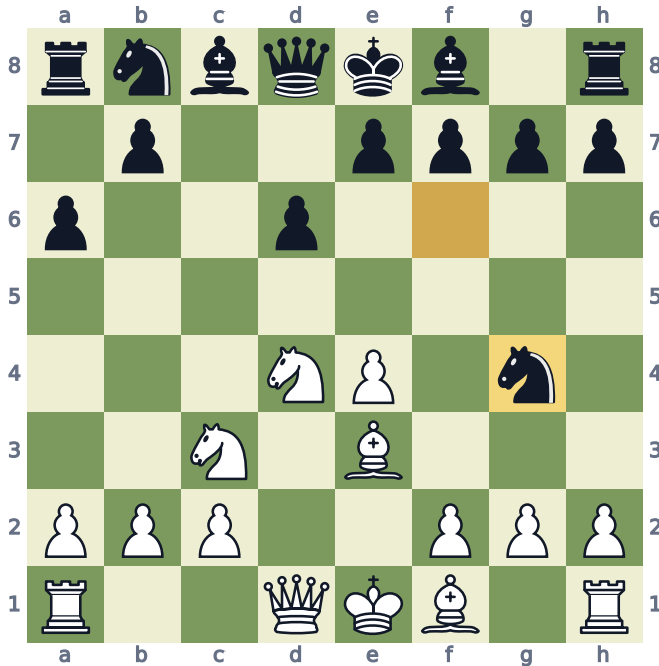
RULE | Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 Ng4 7. Bg5 h6 8. Bh4 g5 9. Bg3 Bg7



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Ng4: Black reroutes a knight to g4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly? White's resistance is: White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares. The line fails as a template when: Continuing the pawn chase after its strategic purpose is complete.

STORE THIS | Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

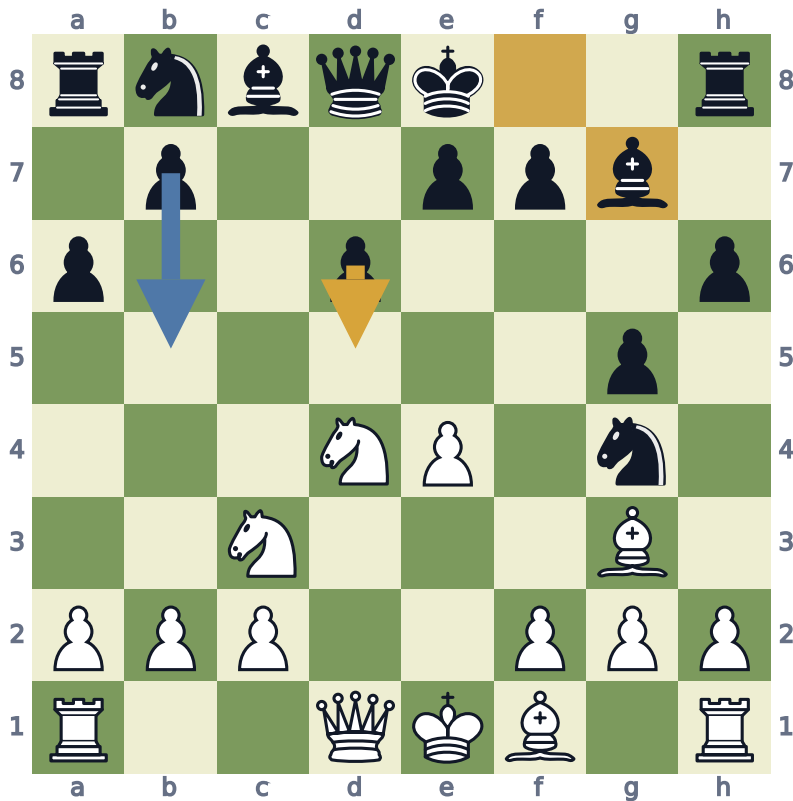
1. ...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares. 2. Use the gained bishop tempo to seize kingside space, then return to development before the advanced pawns become targets. 3. White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares. 4. Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly? 5. Continuing the pawn chase after its strategic purpose is complete.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 Ng4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The ...Ng4 disruption



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares.

DECISION RULE

Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use the gained bishop tempo to seize kingside space, then return to development before the advanced pawns become targets.

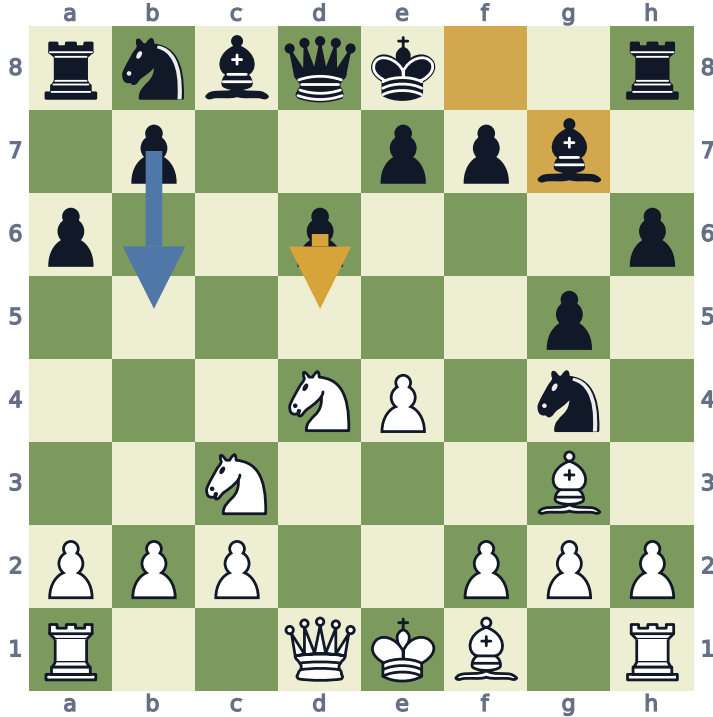
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares.

MEMORY RULE | Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use the gained bishop tempo to seize kingside space, then return to development before the advanced pawns become targets.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares.

FAILURE MODE

Continuing the pawn chase after its strategic purpose is complete.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

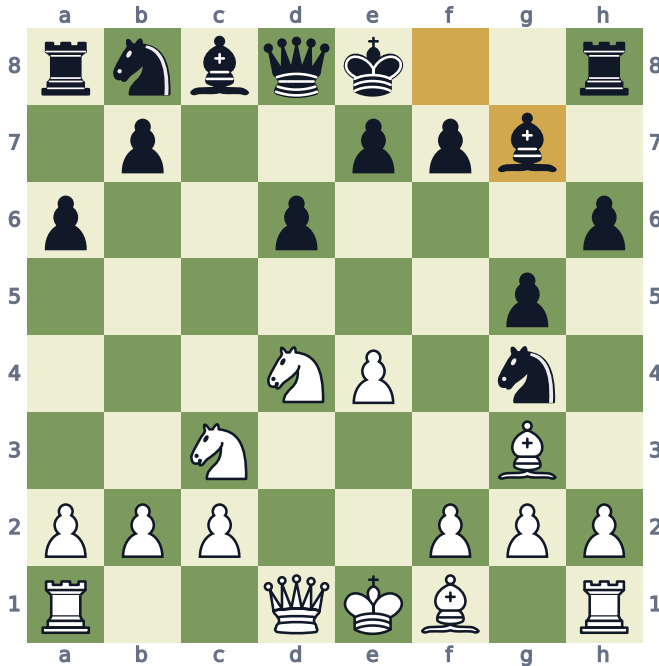
RULE | Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 Ng4 7. Bg5 h6 8. Bh4 g5 9. Bg3 Bg7



- Bg5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bh4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- g5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bg3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly? White's resistance is: White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares. The line fails as a template when: Continuing the pawn chase after its strategic purpose is complete.

STORE THIS | Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

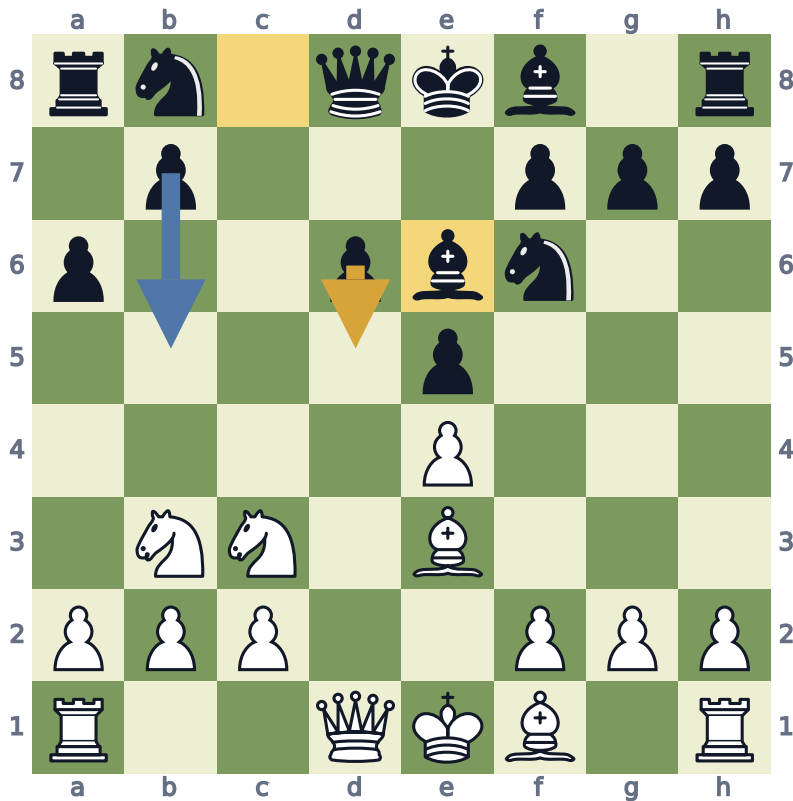
1. ...Ng4 challenges the key e3 bishop before White finishes the attacking setup, but it spends tempi and loosens dark squares. 2. Use the gained bishop tempo to seize kingside space, then return to development before the advanced pawns become targets. 3. White preserves the bishop, attacks the pawn chain, and exploits weakened f5, h5, and dark squares. 4. Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly? 5. Continuing the pawn chase after its strategic purpose is complete.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Bg5 h6 8. Bh4 g5 9. Bg3 Bg7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The ...e5 English Attack structure

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control.

DECISION RULE

Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Control d5, complete development, and use ...b5 while watching whether ...d5 can ever be prepared.

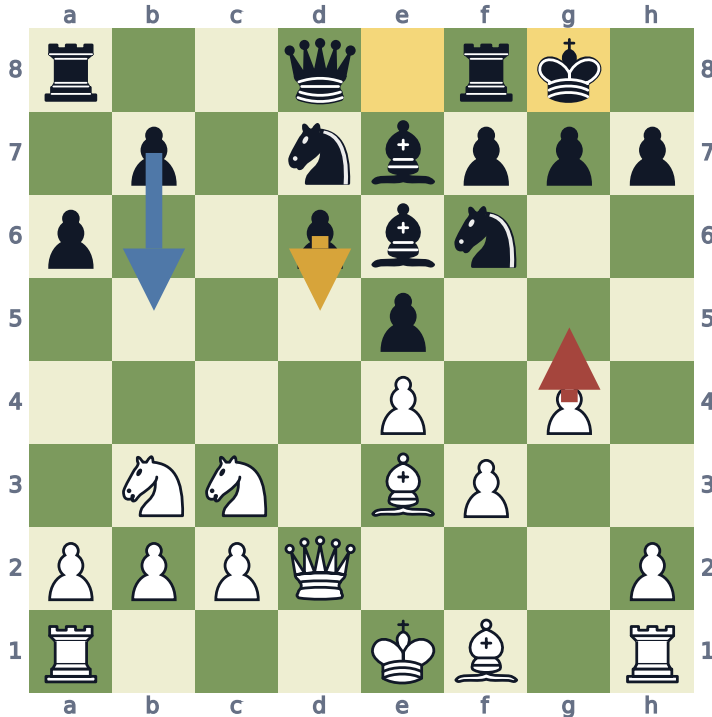
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack.

MEMORY RULE | In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Control d5, complete development, and use ...b5 while watching whether ...d5 can ever be prepared.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack.

FAILURE MODE

Launching queenside play while d5 and d6 collapse in the center.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

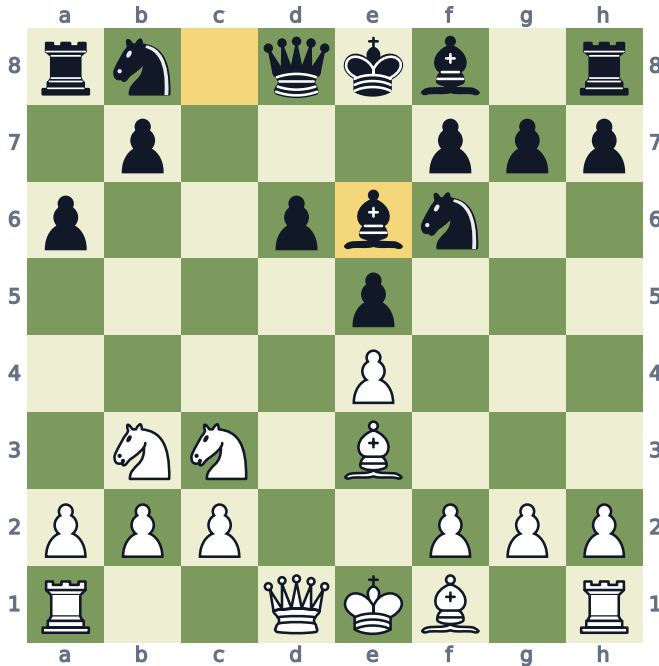
RULE | In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6 8. f3 Nbd7 9. g4 Be7 10. Qd2 O-O



- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.
- Nb3: White reroutes a knight to b3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be6: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it? White's resistance is: White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack. The line fails as a template when: Launching queenside play while d5 and d6 collapse in the center.

STORE THIS | In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

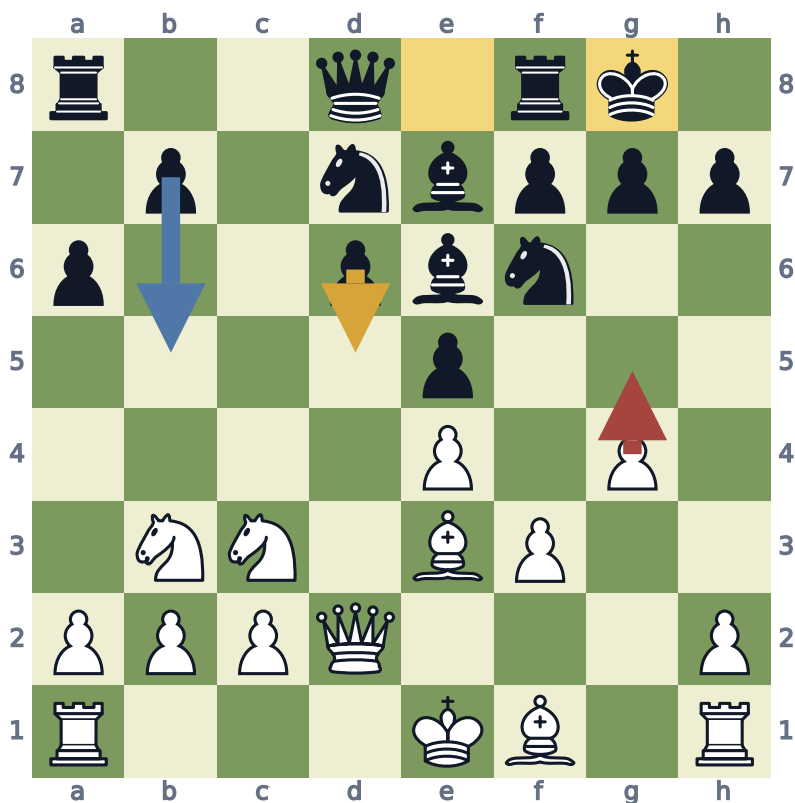
1. Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control. 2. Control d5, complete development, and use ...b5 while watching whether ...d5 can ever be prepared. 3. White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack. 4. Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it? 5. Launching queenside play while d5 and d6 collapse in the center.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The ...e5 English Attack structure



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control.

DECISION RULE

Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Control d5, complete development, and use ...b5 while watching whether ...d5 can ever be prepared.

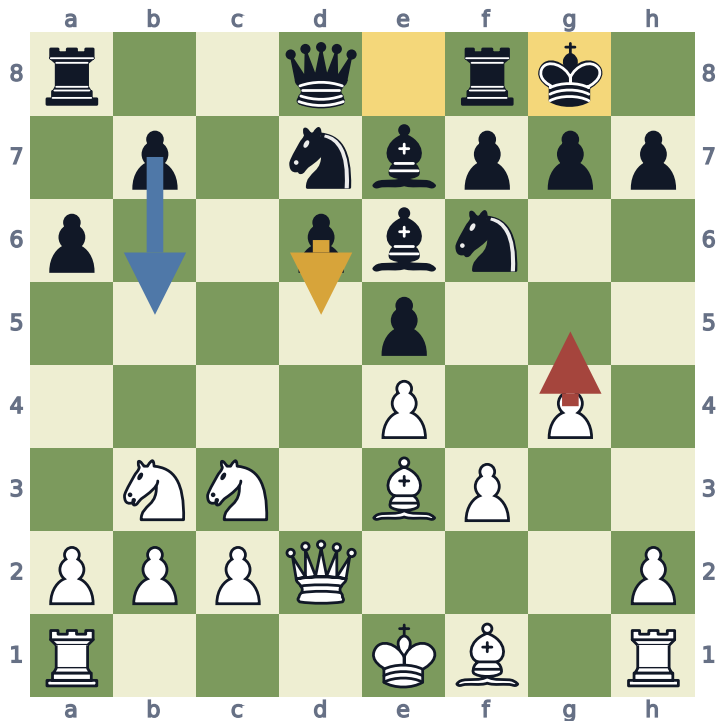
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack.

MEMORY RULE | In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Control d5, complete development, and use ...b5 while watching whether ...d5 can ever be prepared.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack.

FAILURE MODE

Launching queenside play while d5 and d6 collapse in the center.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

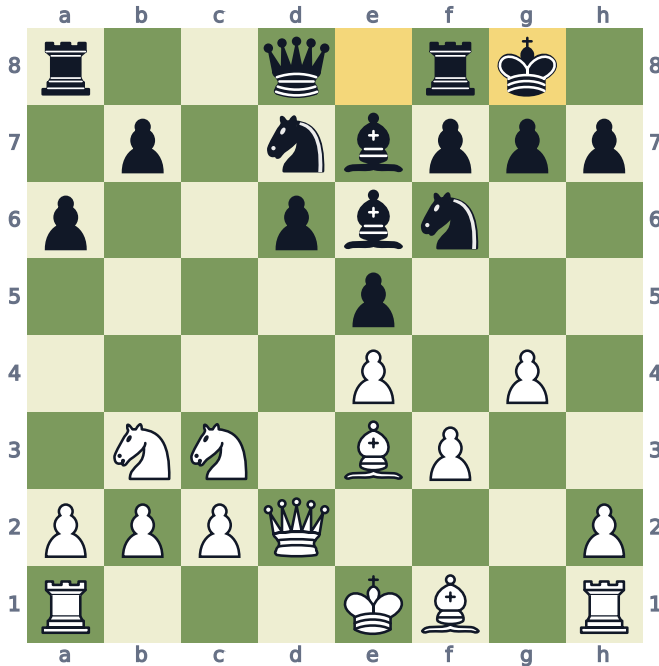
RULE | In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6 8. f3 Nbd7 9. g4 Be7 10. Qd2 O-O



- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- g4: White starts a direct pawn storm and threatens to gain time on the f6 knight.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it? White's resistance is: White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack. The line fails as a template when: Launching queenside play while d5 and d6 collapse in the center.

STORE THIS | In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Black accepts d5 in exchange for central space and a tempo on the knight, producing a slower race with precise square control. 2. Control d5, complete development, and use ...b5 while watching whether ...d5 can ever be prepared. 3. White uses Nd5, g5, and queenside castling to combine an outpost with a direct attack. 4. Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it? 5. Launching queenside play while d5 and d6 collapse in the center.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. f3 Nbd7 9. g4 Be7 10. Qd2 O-O

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 025 Decode: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup

Prompt: Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king?

Recall: In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

LESSON 026 Play: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup

Prompt: Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king?

Recall: In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

LESSON 027 Decode: The ...Ng4 disruption

Prompt: Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly?

Recall: Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

LESSON 028 Play: The ...Ng4 disruption

Prompt: Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly?

Recall: Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

LESSON 029 Decode: The ...e5 English Attack structure

Prompt: Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it?

Recall: In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

LESSON 030 Play: The ...e5 English Attack structure

Prompt: Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it?

Recall: In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7

Decision: Which forcing move changes the race now: a central break, a pawn contact, or a direct threat to the king?

Memory: In opposite-side attacks, count checks, captures, and pawn contacts.

CARD 2

The ...Ng4 disruption

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 Ng4 7. Bg5 h6 8. Bh4 g5 9. Bg3 Bg7

Decision: Does the bishop chase win useful structure or merely move the same knight and pawns repeatedly?

Memory: Disrupt the setup, then develop; harassment is not a development plan.

CARD 3

The ...e5 English Attack structure

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6 8. f3 Nbd7 9. g4 Be7 10. Qd2 O-O

Decision: Can White occupy d5 under favorable exchanges, and which black piece must prevent it?

Memory: In the ...e5 structure, d5 is the alarm bell for every plan.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
025 Decode: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
026 Play: The standard Be3-f3-Qd2-g4 setup	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
027 Decode: The ...Ng4 disruption	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
028 Play: The ...Ng4 disruption	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
029 Decode: The ...e5 English Attack structure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
030 Play: The ...e5 English Attack structure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.